



FREE SAMPLE LESSON PLAN

Ancient Civilizations

Reading Comprehension — The Lost Civilization of the Aztecs

Level	3AS — Troisième Année Secondaire
Textbook	New Prospects, Unit 1
Sequence	Sequence 1 — Reading & Writing
Duration	60 minutes
Class size	32 pupils, mixed ability
Framework	APC-aligned · Bloom's Taxonomy · SMART objectives

Lesson Plan

Field	Value
Level	3AS (Année Secondaire)
Stream	Literary & Philosophy / Foreign Languages (adaptable)
Textbook	New Prospects
Unit / Sequence	Unit 1 — Ancient Civilizations / Sequence 1: Reading & Writing
Lesson title	Reading Comprehension — The Lost Civilization of the Aztecs
Time allotted	60 minutes
Class size	32 pupils, mixed ability
Date	—

Target Competency / Final Objective

By the end of the lesson, learners will be able to **interpret a historical text about an ancient civilization, identify its key features (location, achievements, decline) and produce a short written reaction justifying their personal opinion.**

Can-do statement: "I can read a historical text, locate specific information, infer meaning from context, and write a short response that supports my opinion with evidence from the text."

Learning Objectives (SMART + Bloom's Taxonomy)

By the end of the lesson, learners will be able to:

1. **(Remember)** Identify at least 5 factual details about the Aztec civilization from the text.
2. **(Understand)** Interpret 4 contextual vocabulary items related to civilization and history.
3. **(Apply)** Use scanning & skimming strategies to answer comprehension questions in < 10 minutes.
4. **(Analyze)** Distinguish facts from inferences in a historical text.
5. **(Evaluate / Create)** Produce a 4–5-sentence written reaction justifying a personal opinion with textual evidence.

Cross-curricular & Transversal Competencies

- **Intellectual:** critical thinking, inference, comparison
 - **Methodological:** reading strategies (skimming, scanning, intensive reading), note-taking
 - **Communicative:** expressing opinions in writing, justifying ideas with evidence
 - **Personal & social:** respect for cultural heritage, awareness of historical diversity
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Core Values

- **National identity & openness to the world:** appreciating both Algerian and global cultural heritage.
 - **Citizenship:** valuing the contribution of past civilizations to the modern world.
 - **Critical-mindedness:** distinguishing established facts from interpretations.
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Materials & Teaching Aids

- New Prospects textbook, page 14–15 (essential)
 - Whiteboard / chalkboard + markers (essential)
 - Printed handout: text + tasks (essential, 1 per pupil or 1 per pair)
 - Map of the Americas (optional — can be sketched on the board)
 - Timer / clock (essential for stage timing)
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Anticipated Difficulties

Difficulty	Mitigation
Unfamiliar lexis (civilization, empire, decline, conquer, ruins)	Pre-teach via images, definitions, antonyms; provide a mini glossary on the handout.
Confusion between Aztec / Maya / Inca	Brief board map locating the Aztec empire (Mexico).
Difficulty justifying opinions in writing	Provide sentence starters: "In my opinion... because the text says..."
Mixed ability — weaker readers may finish late	Tiered handout with starred (*) optional questions for fast finishers.

Previous Knowledge

Learners are assumed to: - Know basic past simple tense (covered in 2AS) - Be familiar with the concept of "civilization" from 4AM social studies - Be able to scan a text for specific information

Lesson Stages

Stage	Time	Teacher's Activity	Pupils' Activity	Interaction	Aim
Warm-up	5'	Greets pupils. Shows the eliciting question on the board: "Which ancient civilizations have you heard about?" Writes 3–4 names elicited on the board.	Brainstorm orally; recall names: Egyptians, Greeks, Romans, Carthaginians, Aztecs...	T ↔ Ps	Activate schema; engage learners; introduce the topic.
Lead-in	5'	Shows / sketches a map of the Americas. Asks: "Where would you place the Aztec civilization?" Pre-teaches 4 key items: civilization, empire, ruins, decline (using definition + visuals + example sentences). Concept-checks: "Is a civilization a small village? → No. Are ruins old or new? → Old."	Locate Mexico on the map; repeat new lexis chorally then individually; answer CCQs.	T ↔ Ps	Pre-teach essential lexis; lower the affective filter before reading.
While-reading 1 (skim for gist)	8'	Distributes the text. Sets the task: "Read quickly — you have 3 minutes. Answer: What is the text mainly about?" Sets ICQs: "Are we reading every word? Do we have a lot of time?"	Skim the text individually; choose between three options on the board (a/b/c); compare with a partner.	Individual → P ↔ P	Develop skimming sub-skill; check global understanding.
While-reading 2 (scan for specific info)	12'	Sets 5 comprehension questions: 1) Where did the Aztecs live? 2) When was their empire at its peak? 3) Name 2 achievements. 4) Who conquered them? 5) Find a synonym for "fall".	Scan the text, write short answers in pairs, justify with line references.	P ↔ P	Develop scanning sub-skill; train evidence-based reading.

Stage	Time	Teacher's Activity	Pupils' Activity	Interaction	Aim
Practice (intensive / inference)	10'	Sets 2 inference tasks: T/F + justify ("The Aztecs had a writing system" / "The conquest was peaceful"); 1 inference: "Why does the writer use the word 'tragic' in line 18?" Monitors and supports weaker pairs.	Reread the relevant paragraphs; discuss in pairs; justify orally.	P ↔ P	Move from lower-order to higher-order thinking (Bloom: Analyze).
Production (written reaction)	15'	Sets the task: "In 4–5 sentences, write your reaction: What lesson can today's world learn from the fall of the Aztec empire?" Provides sentence starters on the board (In my opinion... / The text shows that... / I think this is important because...). Circulates and supports.	Plan ideas individually (2'); draft (10'); peer-edit using a 3-point checklist: opinion stated / evidence given / 1 connector used (3').	Individual + P ↔ P	Develop written production; integrate text content with personal opinion (Bloom: Evaluate / Create).
Wrap-up	5'	Invites 2–3 volunteers to read aloud. Gives quick oral feedback. Recaps key vocabulary. Sets homework.	Volunteers share; class listens; copy homework.	T ↔ Ps	Closure; reinforce learning; check affective state.

Total: 60 minutes.

Expected Pupils' Answers

Skim for gist: (b) The Aztec civilization and its decline.

Scan questions: 1. In central Mexico (around Tenochtitlán). 2. The 14th–16th century. 3. Floating gardens, accurate calendar, advanced agriculture, monumental architecture (any 2). 4. The Spanish conquistadors led by Hernán Cortés. 5. Decline / collapse.

Inference: - T/F: "The Aztecs had a writing system." → **True** ("They used pictographic writing..." line 12). - "The conquest was peaceful." → **False** ("violent invasion" / "tragic end" lines 18–19). - Inference on "tragic": the writer expresses regret over the loss of culture, not just the military defeat.

Written reaction (sample):

In my opinion, the fall of the Aztec empire teaches us that no civilization is permanent. The text shows that even powerful empires can collapse when they meet a stronger force. I think this is important because today's nations should value cultural diversity and protect heritage sites for future generations.

Differentiation Strategies

Tier	Strategy
Struggling learners	Provide a glossary box on the handout; pair with a stronger peer; allow 3 of 5 scan questions; sentence starters mandatory in production.
On-level learners	Standard task; encourage at least 1 connector and 1 piece of textual evidence in production.
Advanced learners	Optional starred questions: "Compare the Aztec civilization with one other ancient civilization you know"; encourage 2 connectors and direct quotation in production.

Assessment

Formative (during the lesson): - Monitoring pair work during scan and inference stages. - Quick oral CCQs after the lead-in. - Peer-editing checklist (opinion / evidence / connector).

Summative (end-of-lesson task — written reaction):

Criterion	0	1	2
Task fulfillment	Off-topic / no opinion	Opinion stated, weak evidence	Clear opinion + textual evidence
Organization	No structure	Some logical order	Clear introduction → reasoning → conclusion
Grammar & vocabulary	Frequent errors block meaning	Errors but meaning clear	Few errors; uses lesson lexis
Mechanics	Many issues	Some issues	Spelling & punctuation accurate

Total: /8 — converted to /20 for reporting.

Homework

Write a paragraph (8–10 sentences) titled **"An Ancient Civilization I Admire."** Pupils choose any civilization (Algerian heritage encouraged: Numidians, Carthaginians, Berbers) and follow the same structure: location → achievements → reason for admiration. To be submitted next session.

Remedial Activities

If > 30% of pupils fail the production task: 1. Re-teach the opinion-justification structure with a guided model on the board. 2. Provide a writing frame: In my opinion, ... because ... For example, the text says ... 3. Re-assess with a shorter prompt (2–3 sentences) the following session. 4. Use bilingual support (Arabic / French) only for clarification of complex inference questions.

Classroom Management Tips

1. **Time discipline.** Use a visible timer for each stage; announce 1-minute warnings before transitions.
 2. **Pair formation.** Pre-arrange mixed-ability pairs (one strong + one developing reader) before the lesson to save time.
 3. **Maximize STT (Student Talking Time).** During pair-check phases, sit at one corner of the room and let pupils self-correct — intervene only after 30 seconds.
 4. **Manage the production stage.** Walk a fixed loop around the room; do not get stuck with one pair. Note 2–3 common errors for delayed correction at the wrap-up.
 5. **Closing energy.** End with a positive recap: “Today you read a real historical text, found specific information, and wrote your own reaction in English — well done.”
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Teacher’s Self-Reflection Prompts

1. Which stage took longer than planned, and why? How will I adjust next time?
 2. Did all three ability tiers produce a written response? If not, which differentiation strategy needs strengthening?
 3. Which question generated the deepest discussion? Can I reuse that question type in the next lesson?
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This is a Fearless Creations free sample. The full library of premium lesson plans for 1AS, 2AS, 3AS and BAC preparation is available at creativekidsdigit.github.io.

Appendix — Pupil Handout

Photocopy and distribute one per pupil or per pair. ~ 245 words · B1+ CEFR · adapted for 3AS New Prospects. The line numbers below are the same line numbers referenced in the **Practice (intensive / inference)** stage and in the Expected Pupils' Answers (line 12, lines 18–19).

The Lost Civilization of the Aztecs

1 In the heart of central Mexico, around the great city of Tenochtitlán,
2 there once flourished one of the most fascinating civilizations of the
3 Americas — the Aztec empire. Founded in the early 14th century, the Aztecs
4 built their capital on a small island in Lake Texcoco, and within two
5 hundred years they transformed it into a vast metropolis of palaces and markets.
6 At the peak of their power, between the 14th and the 16th century, the Aztecs
7 ruled over millions of people. Their society was highly organized, with priests,
8 warriors, farmers and skilled artisans. They were remarkable engineers and
9 scientists who left a deep mark on the region. They invented floating gardens
10 called chinampas to grow maize and vegetables directly on the surface of
11 the lake; they followed an accurate solar calendar and observed the stars;
12 they used a pictographic writing system to record laws, history and religion;
13 and they raised monumental architecture — pyramids, plazas and stone
14 sculptures — that still amaze visitors who walk among the ruins today.
15 Yet this brilliant civilization did not last. In 1519, Spanish conquistadors
16 led by Hernán Cortés arrived on the eastern coast and marched towards
17 Tenochtitlán. After two years of fierce resistance, weakened by new diseases
18 brought from Europe, the city fell to a violent invasion that brought a tragic
19 end to centuries of Aztec rule. Temples were destroyed, ancient books were
20 burned, and a unique culture experienced a rapid decline.
21 The collapse of the Aztec empire reminds us that no civilization, however
22 powerful, is eternal. Just as Algerians honour the memory of Numidia and
23 Carthage in their own land, the modern world owes it to itself to study,
24 respect and protect what remains of these ancient peoples everywhere — for
25 each one is part of the shared heritage of humanity.

Tasks

1. Skim for gist (3 min). What is the text mainly about? (a) The geography of Mexico. (b) The Aztec civilization and its decline. (c) Spanish exploration in the 16th century.

2. Scan for specific information (12 min).

1. Where did the Aztecs live?
2. When was their empire at its peak?
3. Name **two** Aztec achievements.
4. Who conquered them?
5. Find a synonym for the word **fall** in the text.

3. Intensive reading & inference (10 min).

- True or false? Justify with a line reference. a. "The Aztecs had a writing system." b. "The conquest was peaceful."
- Why does the writer use the word **tragic** in line 18?

4. Written reaction (15 min). In 4–5 sentences, answer: What lesson can today's world learn from the fall of the Aztec empire?

Sentence starters: In my opinion... / The text shows that... / I think this is important because...

Mini-glossary (for support): civilization = a developed society; empire = a large state ruled by one government; ruins = what remains of old buildings; decline = a slow fall; conquistador = a Spanish soldier-explorer of the 16th century.